

ARCHITECTURAL DOSSIER / 2026

LOUVRE
ABU DHABI
JEAN NOUVEL / 2017
SAADIYAT ISLAND / ABU DHABI, UAE
01



01 / SPATIAL PROLOGUE

RAIN
OF LIGHT
BENEATH A POROUS DOME,
DAYLIGHT BECOMES A
CULTURAL MEDIUM.
The roof does not simply shelter the museum;
it composes its atmosphere.
LOUVRE ABU DHABI
JEAN NOUVEL / 2017
02



02 / GEOMETRY AS CLIMATE

THE DOME

AS INSTRUMENT

Four outer layers of stainless steel
meet four inner layers of aluminium.

A geometric canopy filters daylight, shades
the plaza and generates a microclimate below.

SOURCE / LOUVRE ABU DHABI — ARCHITECTURE

03

7,850

STARS IN THE PATTERN

8

OVERLAPPING LAYERS

180 M

DIAMETER OF THE DOME

NEUTRAL VISUAL FIELD

03 / URBAN FIGURE

A MUSEUM CITY / IN THE SEA
ABU DHABI · UAE
55 BUILDINGS
23 ARE GALLERIES
04



04 / CIVIC INTERIOR

WATER

AS PUBLIC ROOM

Paths cross the water beneath the dome, turning the museum into a walkable, climate-softened urban room.

Architecture is not an object beside the sea.

It becomes a small city within it.

LAND + SEA

05

SOURCE / LOUVRE ABU DHABI — ARCHITECTURE



05 / THERMAL FIELD

SHADE
BECOMES
INFRASTRUCTURE

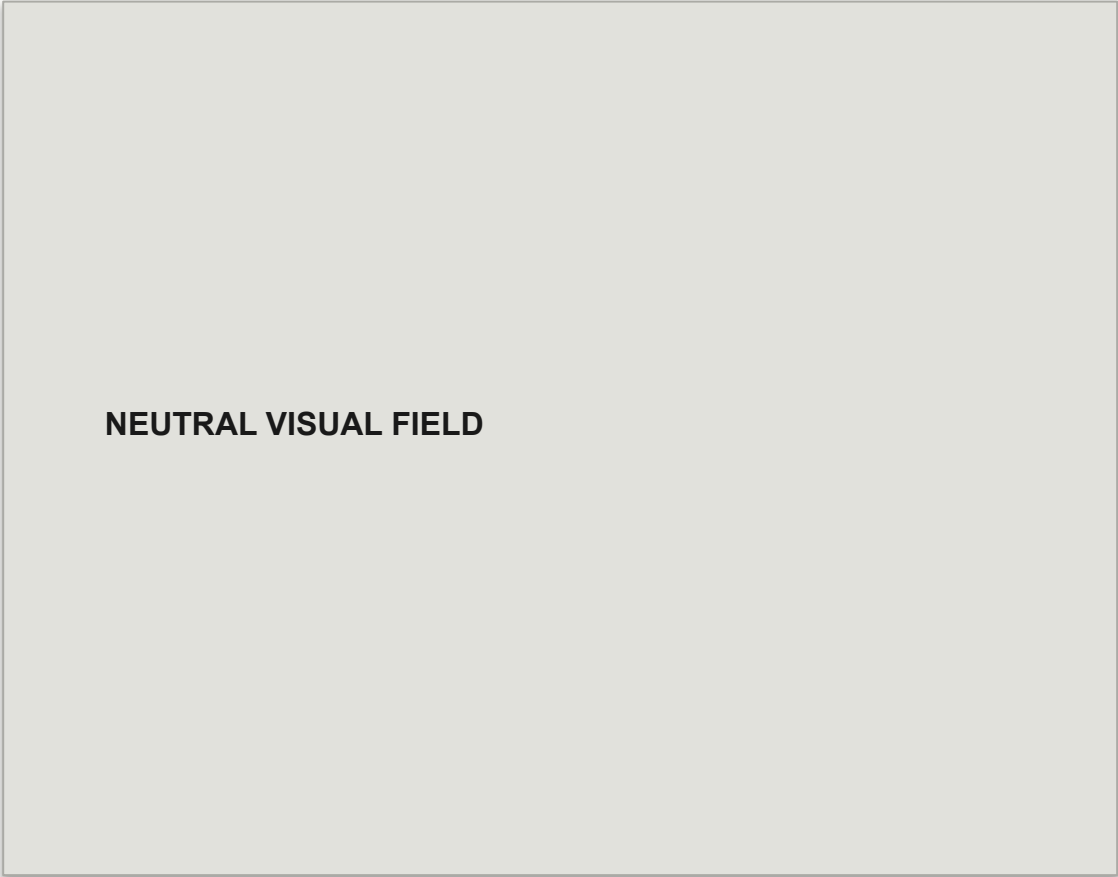
The canopy filters daylight, reduces heat
and protects the public realm below.

Natural cooling is not an add-on.
It is the spatial idea of the project.

36 M
DOME ABOVE GROUND

7,500 T
DOME WEIGHT

SOURCE / LOUVRE ABU DHABI — ARCHITECTURE
06



NEUTRAL VISUAL FIELD

06 / SPATIAL SEQUENCE

WALK / PAUSE / RETURN

A MUSEUM DESIGNED AS A JOURNEY

01 / FILTERED DAYLIGHT

02 / CITY + SEA

03 / CIVIC WATERROOM

THREE ATMOSPHERES, ONE CONTINUOUS ROOF.

07



07 / MATERIAL LOGIC

MATERIAL IS A FILTER

Steel, aluminium and patterned voids work as a single optical instrument between sky and ground.

8 LAYERS

4 STAINLESS STEEL / 4 ALUMINIUM

The roof permits daylight without excessive heat or wind.

SOURCE / LOUVRE ABU DHABI — ARCHITECTURE
08



08 / ARCHITECTURAL POSITION

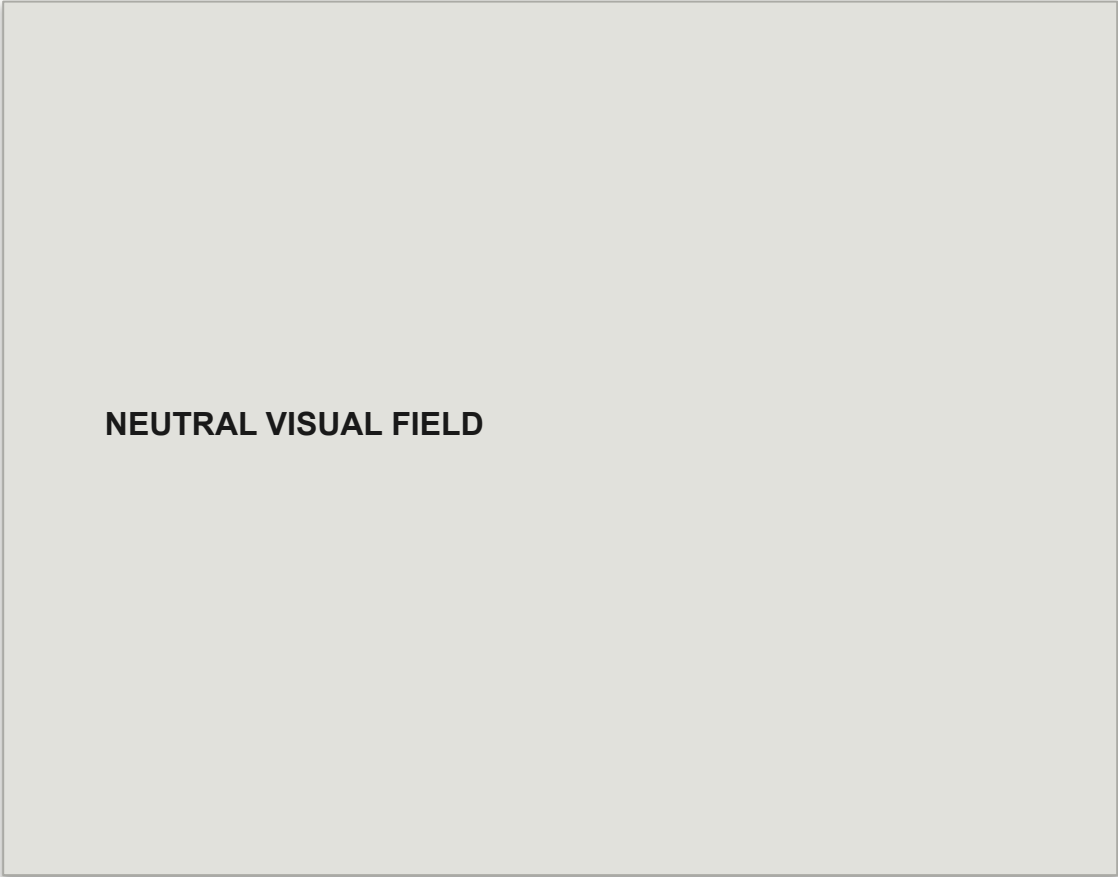
A WELCOMING WORLD
OF LIGHT, SHADOW,
REFLECTION AND CALM.

A museum-city that belongs to its geography
without becoming a literal interpretation of it.

JEAN NOUVEL / ARCHITECT

SOURCE / LOUVRE ABU DHABI — ARCHITECTURE

09



NEUTRAL VISUAL FIELD

09 / CODA

LOUVRE ABU DHABI / SAADIYAT ISLAND
LIGHT.
WATER.
CITY.

A common sky turns architecture
into a public cultural landscape.
END OF STUDY
10

